

Software Engineering/Design Narrative

This artifact is a full-stack web application that is a travel vacation website. The original artifact started development last semester and was finished at the beginning of March. I included this artifact because I think it demonstrates a wide variety of skills ranging from frontend to backend development, API endpoints, HTTP methods, and databases. Specifically, the admin single page application, the frontend website, and the MongoDB database showcase the most skills and abilities. I was not able to complete the original enhancement plan I had laid out as when I tried to implement the idea I had, it was met with too many errors and problems that were rooted deep in the developing code. I simply didn't have the time to essentially rebuild the framework to implement my enhancement. What I went with instead was implementing handlebar views that are displayed on the frontend webpage, rather than the static HTML pages. This makes the web page more dynamic and much more scalable in the long run. Additionally, under the travel section of the website, I added more display information for each of the trips listed from the database. I pulled in additional useful information such as the number of days and nights of each trip, the resort it would be at along with its star rating, and also the cost of the trip per person.

Although I couldn't implement my initial enhancement, I still feel like I met the course outcome I planned to meet. With the changes I made to the web app, I feel like I demonstrated the ability to enhance computer software through using techniques that improve the value of the web app. Generating views from handlebars rather than static HTML is important for the scalability and functionality of the web app. Also, displaying more trip information provides users with more knowledge firsthand, which users of a website can appreciate. Once I decided I needed to switch enhancement ideas, the process was fairly straightforward. The home page and

the travel page were already rendered using handlebars, so I just needed to implement the same rendering for the remaining pages. One challenge I ran into was once every page was implemented to render with handlebars, the static HTML pages would still render when using the navigation bar and footer. Because of this, I had to edit the header and footer .hbs files to also render the pages using handlebars, as they were still set to render the static HTML pages.